



Slop / University

The Sort That Keeps Watching Itself

An assignment is a claim, not a form.



Why Slop University

Most institutions sort you once. A seating group is set in week one and left to speak for the whole term; a badge is issued after a scare and never asked whether the scare is still current; a waitlist position becomes a scorecard rank and nobody checks whether the two still agree. Slop University's two Schools have built a habit around the opposite instinct. The School of Emergent Priorities studies how a decision, once made, keeps making itself long after the meeting that produced it; the School of Continuous Improvement studies what happens when somebody finally goes back and checks. Between them, an assignment stops being a form completed and starts being a claim under standing review.

This brochure is an introduction to that habit at work: a table-colour group that outlived the quiz that set it, a workroom badge that survived the scare it answered, a parking-permit score audited line by line against the waitlist it replaced. None of it is presented as finished. Each is presented as still open, the way the University now expects every assignment it makes to stay.



The short version

Three things every assignment can expect from us.



One habit, two Schools

The School of Emergent Priorities studies a decision before it's due; the School of Continuous Improvement checks it after it's made. Together, nothing gets sorted only once.



Nothing closes on issue

A seating group, a badge requirement, a permit tier: each stays open to review long after the day it was assigned.



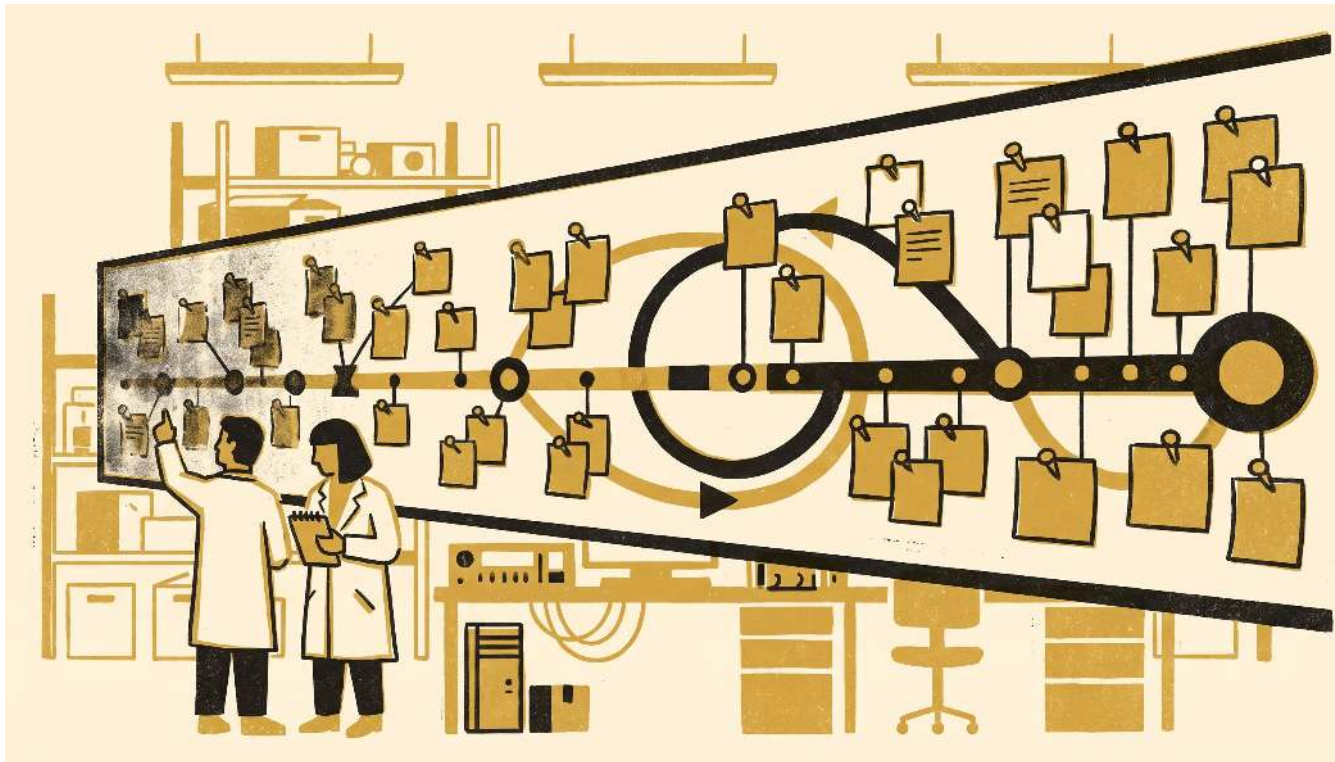
The reason gets checked too

An arrangement is revisited for whether its original justification still holds, not only for whether it's still in place.

Where ideas count

The Trajectory Analytics Group

Every institution accumulates commitments faster than it revisits them: a plan approved in one budget cycle is still governing decisions three cycles later, unexamined because nobody scheduled the examination. The Trajectory Analytics Group, the School of Emergent Priorities' flagship research group, treats that accumulation as the object of study rather than an unfortunate side effect of institutional life. Its researchers follow a single commitment from the day it is minuted to the point, years on, where somebody finally asks whether the conditions that justified it are still true. The Group's current work follows three of the University's own sorting habits through exactly that arc, using nothing more exotic than the records the University already keeps on itself.

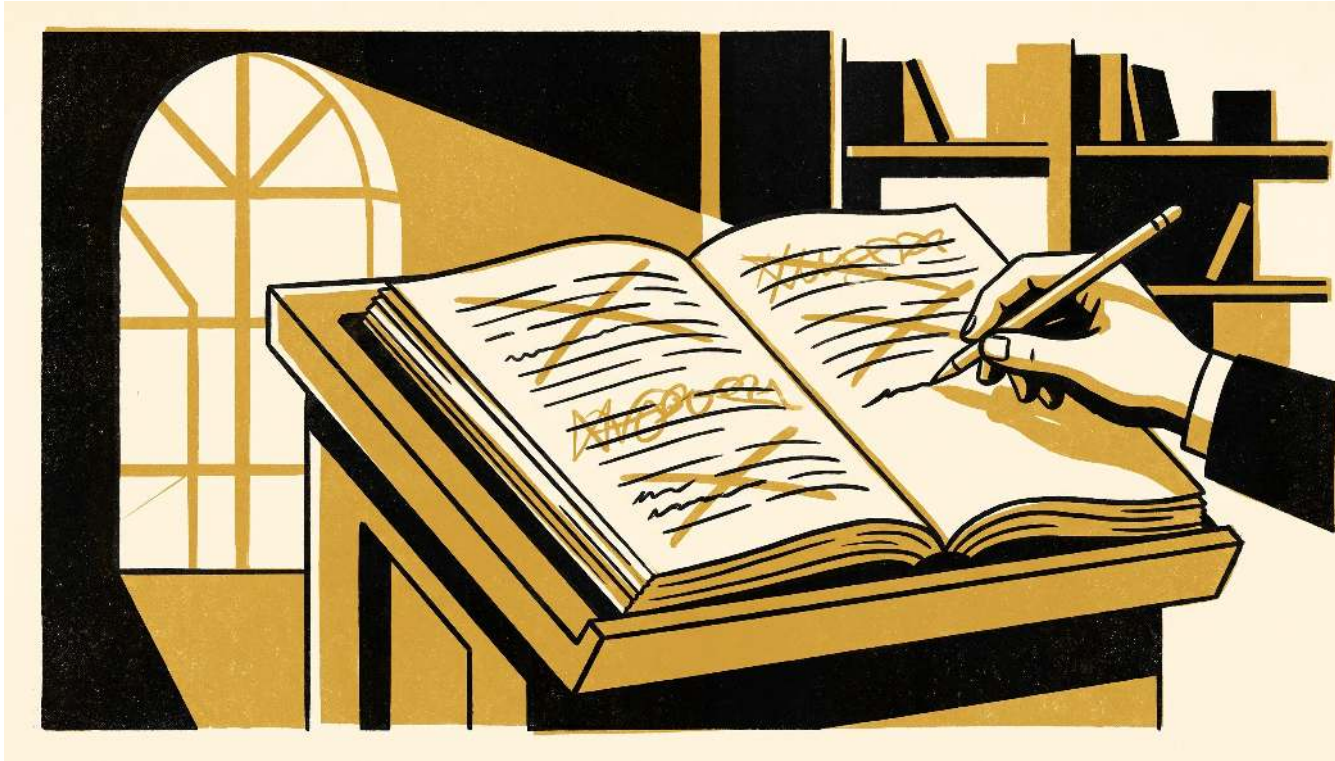


A priority doesn't expire on its own. Somebody has to be the one who notices it should have.

— Professor Verity Marris, Director, Trajectory Analytics Group, School of Emergent Priorities

The Horizon Register

The Horizon Register holds every priority the School of Emergent Priorities has flagged as on approach, and it is unusual among registers in this: entries are expected to leave it. Dr Fenna Okoro's work traces how a register entry is drafted, revised as circumstances shift, and — eventually, and this is the hard part — retired, rather than left to accumulate as an ever-growing list nobody prunes. The Register's edit history is itself a dataset: which entries survive a first review, which get quietly extended a second time, and which are still open a decade after the horizon they described has arrived and passed. A rolling register that never retires anything, Dr Okoro's research holds, has stopped being a register and become an archive with a misleading name.



An item that's still on the horizon after ten years was never on the horizon. It was just left there.

— Dr Fenna Okoro, Senior Lecturer and Convenor, Horizon Register, School of Emergent Priorities

Futures in Committee

Futures in Committee, the School of Emergent Priorities' seminar series, exists because the interesting part of a foresight exercise is rarely the workshop that opens it — it's the minute that closes it. Dr Ingrid Vasseur convenes the series to compare how the same open question reads in a scanning workshop against how it reads three meetings later, once it has become an agenda item with a recommendation attached and a vote already taken. Her comparative record follows a question from its most speculative form through to the point a committee treats it as settled, and asks how much of the original uncertainty survived the trip. Not all of it, her work suggests. But the series exists to keep checking exactly how much.



A committee doesn't close a question. It just stops writing down that it's still open.

— Dr Ingrid Vasseur, Lecturer and Convenor, Futures in Committee, School of Emergent Priorities

From our researchers

Three recent studies, each catching an assignment still at work long after the day it was made.

- **Sorted Once, Seated All Term** — Lindiwe Achterberg and Anouk Mensah track a week-one diagnostic seating group against week-nine performance, and find the group outlasting its own explanatory power. [doi:10.5555/slop.jkkydn](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.jkkydn)
- **The Badge Outlived the Scare** — Marek Solheim and Kwame Lindqvist follow a badge-tap requirement introduced after a timesheet-rounding scare, and ask whether marking simply moved to the room next door. [doi:10.5555/slop.cqmkhr](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.cqmkhr)
- **New Scorecard, Same Waitlist** — Kwame Lindqvist, Ingrid Vasseur, and Dagny Okafor audit a priority-tier parking-permit score against the blanket waitlist it replaced, applicant by applicant. [doi:10.5555/slop.6apmck](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.6apmck)

The people behind the work

Dr Lindiwe Achterberg, Lecturer in the School of Emergent Priorities, follows initiatives that stay in trial status year after year — including, this time, a seating group nobody remembered was only ever meant for week one.

Associate Professor Kwame Lindqvist, of the School of Emergent Priorities, studies the point at which a priority acquires a budget line, a badge reader, or a scoring formula well before anyone revisits whether it should keep one.

Dr Dagny Okafor, Lecturer and Convenor of Evaluation of Evaluation in the School of Continuous Improvement, convenes the School's program for reviewing its own reviews — the discipline this brochure's whole case for support depends on.

Your next step

None of this asks you to take the University's word for it. Every study behind this brochure carries a DOI that resolves on our own site, to the same figures a reviewer would check: the seating group's fading explanatory power, the badge reader's displaced marking hours, the parking score's applicant-by-applicant match against the waitlist it replaced.

If an assignment made about you is still doing work you didn't expect, the School of Emergent Priorities would like to hear about it, and the School of Continuous Improvement would like to check it. Prospective researchers are welcome to sit in on a Horizon Register review, follow a Futures in Committee session to its minuted end, or bring us an arrangement you suspect has outlived its reason.

We don't promise every sort was right. We promise to keep checking. Come and see what else Slop University has decided isn't finished yet.



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